

Same Object, Different AOK Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Cross-AOK • 30-40 min

Category	Cross-AOK	Time	30-40 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	same-object-different-aok

Big idea: One object can carry many kinds of knowledge.

Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: A shell, coin, photograph, or medicine bottle examined by multiple AOKs. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A matrix with rows for AOK and columns for questions, methods, and evidence. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Same Object, Different AOK Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A debrief on whether the object changes or the knower's purpose changes. Name the AOK, the method being used, and the standard of evidence you would apply.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — One object can carry many kinds of knowledge.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students
1	After inspecting Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?
2	Which exact detail from Same Object, Different AOK Stimulus A did you use as evidence?
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?
6	How does context change what an object helps us know?

Ready-to-Use Examples

- A shell, coin, photograph, or medicine bottle examined by multiple AOKs.
- A matrix with rows for AOK and columns for questions, methods, and evidence.
- A debrief on whether the object changes or the knower's purpose changes.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Cross-AOK.

Activity Steps

1. Place the object in the centre of the room or slide.
2. Groups rotate through AOK stations and add one insight at each station.
3. After the rotation, groups identify which AOK produced the most surprising knowledge.
4. Students formulate a TOK exhibition-style commentary.

Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

What I noticed	What I inferred	Evidence	Confidence

TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: How does context change what an object helps us know?
- Can one object belong to many knowledge communities?
- What makes an object suitable for the TOK exhibition?

Knowledge Questions

- How does context change what an object helps us know?
- Can one object belong to many knowledge communities?
- What makes an object suitable for the TOK exhibition?

Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with a shell, coin, photograph, or medicine bottle examined by multiple aoks. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...